Health and Physical Activity

Music On Do you think physical activity is always ***helpful*** to your health? The relationship between health and physical activity has changed over time.

Music On For generations, people farmed, hunted, and built things. This kind of work involved a high level of physical activity. It made people very tired. In ancient Greece and Rome, people lived only about twenty-eight years on average.

Music On In contrast, by the end of the twentieth century, people in developed countries lived about seventy-four years on average. These days, machines do hard work instead of people in many industries. So we participate in fewer physical activities compared to the past. However, is this situation really good for our health?

Music On The answer is no. Most scientists say that modern people need physical activities. The lack of physical activity is a serious problem these days. If you want better health, you must get exercise regularly. However, that does not mean that we have to do ①_____ work. Just regular exercises like walking or swimming are enough.

Check T for true or F for false.

	T	F
1. A high level of physical activity is always helpful for human health.	☐	☐
2. The average life span in the past was shorter than it is in the present.	☐	☐
3. People in modern society need physical activity.	☐	☐
4. People who are not physically active live long lives.	☐	☐

Reading Comprehension

Quick Reading

Read and answer the questions.

1. What is the main idea of the passage?

ⓐ People have to exercise hard.
ⓑ Modern people live longer than ancient people.
ⓒ In ancient Greece and Rome, people did hard physical work.
ⓓ The relationship between health and physical activity has changed.

2. What does the word *helpful* mean?

ⓐ beneficial
ⓑ hopeless
ⓒ hopeful
ⓓ harmful

Careful Reading

Read the text carefully and answer the questions.

1. Which is NOT true according to the passage?

ⓐ Ancient people lived only about twenty-eight years on average.
ⓑ Modern people live about seventy-four years on average.
ⓒ A high level of physical activity made ancient people tired.
ⓓ Participating less in physical activity is good for your health in the present.

2. Which is NOT true about modern people?

ⓐ They participate less in physical activity.
ⓑ They need to do regular exercises like walking or swimming.
ⓒ They should do hard work just like people in the past.
ⓓ Machines do hard work instead of people in many industries.

3. Which word is most appropriate for the blank ①_____ in the last paragraph?

ⓐ easy
ⓑ hard
ⓒ mental
ⓓ funny

Sentence Focus I

Choose the correct word(s) and rewrite the sentences.

1. Do you think physical activity is **[helpful always / always helpful]** to your **[health / healthy]**?

2. The relationship between health and physical activity **[have / has]** changed **[during / over]** time.

3. These days, **[machines / machine]** do hard work instead of people in many **[industries / industry]**.

4. We participate in **[fewer / fewest]** physical activities **[compare / compared]** to the past.

5. The lack of physical activity **[is / are]** a **[seriously / serious]** problem these days.

6. Just **[regularly / regular]** exercises like walking or swimming **[are / is]** enough.

Sentence Focus Ⅱ

Put the words in the correct order.

1. of work involved this kind physical activity. a high level of

_____

2. in ancient about twenty-eight years on average. lived only people Greece and Rome,

_____

_____

3. in developed countries, on average. lived people about seventy-four years

_____

4. really however, is this our health? good for situation

_____

5. need say that physical activities. modern people most scientists

_____

6. hard work. does not mean that have to do that we

_____

Outline of the Reading

Fill in the blanks using the words from the box.

1st Paragraph

What question does the writer ask?

Is physical activity is always _____ for our health?

The _____ between health and physical activity has changed over time.

2nd Paragraph

What did people do in the past?

For _____, ancient people had to farm, hunt, and build, which required a _____ level of physical activity.

3rd Paragraph

How are modern times different?

_____ do hard work instead of people in many industries.

People participate in fewer physical activities _____ to the past.

4th Paragraph

What should modern people do?

They must exercise _____. A lack of physical activity is a serious problem these days. Hard work is not necessary. Exercises like walking or swimming are _____.

regularly	high	helpful	compared
relationship	enough	generations	machines

Reading Skills

Summary

Fill in the blanks using the words from the box.

For generations, people in 1 _____ times had to do a high level of physical activity such as 2 _____, hunting, and building. This kind of work made them tired, and they lived only twenty-eight years on 3 _____. People at the end of 20th century lived about seventy-four years. Machines do hard work 4 _____ of people. So people can participate in fewer physical activities compared to the 5 _____. The lack of physical activity has become a serious 6 _____ these days. For 7 _____ health, people nowadays must 8 _____ regularly.

average	exercise	instead	farming
problem	ancient	past	better

Problem and Solution

Fill in the blanks using the words from the box.

Problems

· As machines do _____ work instead of people, the _____ of physical activity has _____ a serious problem in modern society.

Solution

· Hard work is not _____, but _____ exercises like walking or swimming are enough.

regular	hard	necessary	become	lack